

Hostel Handbook 2025-26

1. Scope

This handbook governs all students residing in Institute hostels (Blocks A through F, and the Postgraduate Residence). It is incorporated by reference into Section 15 of the Academic and Administrative Regulations. Where this handbook is silent on a matter of academic consequence, the main Regulations govern. The Institute's standard night curfew for all hostel residents, referenced throughout this document, is **11:00 PM**.

2. Room Allotment

2.1 Room allotment is done by the Hostel Office based on year of study, programme, and, where applicable, medical or accessibility requirements declared at the time of admission.

2.2 First-year students are allotted shared rooms (two or three occupants). From the second year onward, students may apply for single rooms subject to availability, on a seniority-cum-CGPA basis.

2.3 Room changes after the start of a semester are permitted only through the Hostel Office, on documented grounds (health, safety, or serious interpersonal conflict certified by the Warden).

2.4 Students are responsible for the condition of allotted furniture and fittings. Damage beyond normal wear is charged to the occupant(s) of the room at the time of the annual inspection.

3. Mess and Dining

3.1 Resident students on the "with mess" fee plan (see `fee_deadlines.md`) are entitled to three meals a day at the hostel mess during posted timings.

3.2 Mess timings are: Breakfast 7:30-9:30 AM, Lunch 12:30-2:30 PM, Dinner 7:30-9:30 PM. Timings may be adjusted during examination periods with prior notice.

3.3 Students on the "without mess" plan may purchase individual meals at the mess counter at posted per-meal rates, subject to availability.

3.4 Outside food delivery is permitted at the hostel gate up to 10:00 PM on weekdays and 11:00 PM on weekends, subject to the general curfew provisions of Section 5.

4. Guest Policy

4.1 Guests (visiting family or friends who are not Institute students) may visit common areas of the hostel between 9:00 AM and 8:00 PM, after signing the visitor register at the gate.

4.2 Overnight stays by guests are not permitted in student rooms under any circumstances. Parents or guardians requiring overnight accommodation should be directed to the Institute Guest House.

4.3 Opposite-gender visitors are permitted only in designated common lounges, not in individual rooms, at any time.

5. Curfew and Night-Out Policy

5.1 All resident students must be back within hostel premises by **10:00 PM** on all days of the week. The hostel gate is locked at 10:00 PM and entry after this time requires sign-in with the on-duty warden.

5.2 Students wishing to be out of the hostel beyond the curfew for a specific, pre-planned reason (attending a family event, a late academic project session, travel to/from railway station or airport) must obtain a Night-Out Pass from the Warden's office at least four hours in advance, stating the reason and expected time of return.

5.3 A student holding a valid Night-Out Pass who returns to the hostel after **11:00 PM** must additionally inform the security desk on duty and sign the late-entry register, regardless of the time noted on the Pass.

5.4 Repeated late entry (more than three instances in a semester) without a Night-Out Pass is treated as a hostel disciplinary matter under Section 8 and may result in loss of hostel privileges, but does not by itself affect examination eligibility, which is governed solely by Section 3 of the main Regulations.

5.5 Female students in Blocks E and F are subject to the same curfew timing as all other residents; no separate or earlier curfew applies under this handbook.

6. Health and Safety

6.1 Every hostel block has a designated First Aid room staffed during daytime hours. For emergencies outside these hours, students should contact the Warden on duty or the Institute's 24-hour medical helpline.

6.2 Students with known medical conditions requiring regular medication or emergency response plans are strongly encouraged to inform their Warden and roommate, though this is voluntary and not a hostel requirement.

6.3 Ragging in any form is strictly prohibited and is treated as a serious disciplinary matter, reportable to the Institute's Anti-Ragging Committee in addition to any hostel-level action. This is governed by the Institute's separate Anti-Ragging Policy, which takes precedence over any provision in this handbook.

6.4 Smoking, consumption of alcohol, and possession of any prohibited substance within hostel premises is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate disciplinary referral.

7. Electrical Appliances

7.1 Students may keep personal electrical appliances of low wattage (laptop chargers, phone chargers, table lamps, personal fans) in their rooms without prior approval.

7.2 High-wattage appliances (electric kettles, induction cooktops, room heaters, refrigerators) require prior written approval from the Hostel Office due to electrical load and fire safety considerations. Unapproved high-wattage appliances found during inspection will be confiscated and returned only at the end of the academic year.

7.3 Cooking of any kind inside individual rooms is prohibited regardless of appliance approval status; approved appliances such as kettles may be used only for boiling water or heating pre-cooked food.

8. Disciplinary Process

8.1 Minor hostel infractions (curfew violations without repeated pattern, appliance violations, noise complaints) are handled directly by the Warden, who may issue a verbal warning, written warning, or minor fine.

8.2 Serious or repeated infractions are referred to the Hostel Disciplinary Committee, chaired by the Chief Warden, which may recommend suspension of hostel accommodation for a specified period or, in severe cases, permanent removal from hostel accommodation.

8.3 A student removed from hostel accommodation under 8.2 remains enrolled as a student of the Institute and retains all academic rights and examination eligibility under the main Regulations, provided no separate academic disciplinary action has been initiated.

8.4 Appeals against a Hostel Disciplinary Committee decision may be made in writing to the Dean of Student Affairs within seven working days of the decision being communicated.

9. Check-out and Vacation Period

9.1 Students must vacate hostel rooms within three days of their last examination each semester, unless prior written permission to stay longer is obtained from the Hostel Office (for example, students awaiting internship placement travel or those with pending academic work).

9.2 During semester breaks, hostels operate on a reduced-staff, restricted-access basis. Students wishing to reside in the hostel during a break must apply at least one week in advance and may be charged a nominal vacation-residence fee.

9.3 Personal belongings left in rooms beyond the vacate deadline without prior permission may be moved to a common storage area at the student's risk; the Institute does not accept liability for loss or damage to such stored items.

10. Amendments

This handbook may be amended by the Hostel Office with the approval of the Dean of Student Affairs. Amendments take effect from the date of notification on hostel notice boards and are not retroactive to incidents occurring before notification.